Later, elephants are mentioned.

From a period prior to the seventh century **B.C.,** and for ages afterwards, there is some evidence of relations between Persia and India through trade, especially early commerce between India and Babylon, which it is believed, was largely via the Persian Gulf.* From the sixth century onwards direct contacts

**Prof. A. V. Willaims Jackson, in 'The Cambridge History of India,' Vol I, p. 329.*

grew through the campaigns of Cyrus and Darius. **After Alex-**ander's conquest Iran was for many centuries under Greek rule. Contacts with India continued and Ashoka's buildings, it is said, were influenced by the architecture of Persepolis. T h e Graeco-Buddhist art that developed in north-west India and Afghanis-tan has also the touch of Iran. During the Gupta period in India, in the fourth and fifth centuries **A.C**., which is noted for its artistic and cultural activities, contacts with Iran continued.

The borderland areas of Kabul, Kandahar, and Seistan, which were often politically parts of India, were the meeting place of Indians and Iranians. In later Parthian times they were called 'White India.' Referring to these areas, the French savant, James